

Dan Dobrick

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Backend engineer with ten years of experience building Ruby on Rails systems, from payments and billing at Shopify to ed-tech products at brightwheel. I take ambiguous, cross-service problems from vendor negotiation through architecture, rollout, and measurement.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Ruby, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript

Frameworks & APIs: Ruby on Rails, Sidekiq, GraphQL, gRPC/protobuf, REST APIs, Node.js, React, Next.js

Data & messaging: PostgreSQL (PostGIS), MySQL, Redis, BigQuery, Kafka

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, GCP, AWS, CircleCI, Grafana

Integrations: Razorpay, Stripe, BigCommerce, Google Maps/Places

AI tooling: pi as my daily driver, with herdr to run and organize many parallel agent sessions; Claude, GPT, GLM, and other models (via OpenRouter and Fireworks), chosen per task

WORK EXPERIENCE

Shopify

Senior Software Engineer

Jun. 2024 – Present

On a 7-engineer team running the billing platform that invoices and collects payment from every Shopify merchant (~\$7B USD/yr), including PCI-scoped and internationally regulated payment flows. Own payments and payment methods end to end, and all India payments.

- Led on-session payments for Indian merchants across four teams: time-to-pay cut from ~30 hours to ~30 seconds and success rate raised from ~40% to ~60%, across ~400k merchants and ~\$65M USD in the first year. Pushed Razorpay to fix their token endpoint rather than build their recommended redirect flow, and built the dashboards (by gateway and session type) that measure it.
- Technical lead on re-architecting Shopify's credit card vaulting and payment systems, migrating the standalone card vault into the company-wide vault, touching every codebase behind the card payments Shopify collects from merchants. Drove the planning (one engineer and 4+ teams as sounding boards); mapped three architectures, then paused the build to fix the design rather than ship the faster path.
- Designed Billing's payment-method ownership model and the resulting responsibility split with the platform-wide vault team (three design docs, three teams affected), built to eliminate an org-wide payment-method fan-out and unblock projects the old model could not support.
- Migrated usage-based billing (~\$100M/month) from integer to decimal precision across two services with zero revenue impact, removing a micro-unit scaling workaround for API clients.
- Designed and shipped the billing platform's public GraphQL API (public-by-default schema, per-field restrictions, OAuth scopes, identity headers for role-based access), replacing a legacy proxy for most merchants and enabling role-based billing permissions for multi-store enterprise accounts.
- Helped build the team's AI coding-agent guidance and PR workflow.

brightwheel

Staff Software Engineer

Feb. 2020 – May 2024

Promoted from Senior Software Engineer, Jan. 2023

- Led a 2–3 engineer team that rebuilt the education product from the ground up while integrating an acquired company's curriculum business; designed the data structure and API for its content as requirements shifted substantially.

- Orchestrated third-party APIs, including BigCommerce and Stripe, behind a new e-commerce frontend to modernize the purchase flow for a 30-year-old curriculum company.
- Set team priorities, planned sprints, resolved contentious issues, ran technical interviews, mentored engineers, and maintained and monitored infrastructure.
- Sole backend engineer on a greenfield Marketplace, from concept to launch, growing to thousands of listings; built PostGIS geocoding and location search and integrated Google Maps and Places.
- Cut CI build times 90% by optimizing the Next.js and CircleCI pipelines.
- Contributed to a high-traffic Rails application, including a greenfield "flexible form" product for daycare applications.
- Authored design documents and led technical reviews, owning resolution of disagreements.

Jellyvision

Senior Software Engineer

Dec. 2016 – Feb. 2020

- Led a three-person team to build a "doctor finder" feature: TypeScript + Node back end with a React front end.
- Subject-matter expert for the Ruby on Rails and Grape API that powers ALEX conversations, receiving up to 20M+ requests daily.

EDUCATION

Loyola University Chicago

Master of Education (M.Ed.), 2015

University of California, Santa Cruz

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Mathematics, 2011

Dev Bootcamp

Immersive web development program (Ruby on Rails), 2016